oversized men's clothes, a wish granted. I find it hard to recognise myself. It feels good.

There's no sign of a cricket pitch as we enter the stadium, it's like being in the bowels of an alien aircraft, the stamping of a crowd you still cannot see cannoning off the underground car park. As we walk out of the dressing room, back through the car park and up a ramp, the spikes on my shoes echo with a sense of fragility. Just out of sight, up the hill, there's a bright, blinding light. As we get closer, I feel my stride lengthening, walking myself higher and further, beyond the car park towards the pitch. For a split second, it is difficult to distinguish the distance and time between those Burnley truant walks and the walk here now. It is almost as if by simply wishing to be someone else I have become this person now. Who that is, I am not yet sure. And neither is anyone else. Due to the lateness of my emergency call-up, the huge ballooning shirt has no name on the back. I am not just unknown to myself, but literally unknown to anyone. The Melbourne Cricket Ground, like those escape routes in Burnley, also tests you, dares you to walk up that ramp and into that coliseum. For some, the game is already lost just on that walk.

Everyone else in the team wears shirts with their name on, most of them players I only know from television; people I was idolising years ago, film stars I hadn't even imagined to be real. Even these hardened professionals look a bit overawed, walking out at the MCG next to me, looking as if they are circling 360 degrees on the way to the middle, just trying to somehow process the largeness of the ground and the odd inverted vertigo that comes from being in the middle of it. It is a huge, stacked, concrete block of seats, with no eyeline or horizon beyond it. It is a cricket stadium so removed from the one in Burnley I have spent my life playing on that it hardly resembles the same sport. I am opening the bowling and fielding at fine leg, right next to Bay 13. No one has told me that fielding in front of Bay 13 is a kind of initiation reserved for new players, somewhere no one else wants to go, famed as it is for being the rowdiest part of the stadium. I am standing there, no name, my back to the baying masses, trying to ignore the insults. They are shouting 'who are you?' and 'water boy', again and again. They are constantly reminding me of my blank shirt, that no one has seen or heard of me before, that I am just making up the numbers, that they are never going to see me again. They are enlarged, mammoth versions of my